

Brief · Rohan Sharma

```
@import url('https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?family=Poppins:wght@400;500;600;700&display=swap');
```

```
@page {
```

```
size: A4;
```

```
margin: 10mm 12mm 12mm 12mm;
```

```
}
```

```
* { box-sizing: border-box; }
```

```
html { -webkit-text-size-adjust: 100%; }
```

```
body {
```

```
margin: 0;
```

```
padding: 0;
```

```
font-family: 'Poppins', 'Segoe UI', sans-serif;
```

```
font-size: 11pt;
```

```
line-height: 1.55;
```

```
color: #1a365d;
```

```
background: #fff;
```

```
}
```

```
.page-root { max-width: 100%; }
```

```
.topbar {
```

```
display: flex;
```

```
justify-content: space-between;
```

```
align-items: flex-end;
```

```
border-bottom: 4px solid #e67e22;
```

```
padding-bottom: 10px;
```

```
margin-bottom: 14px;
```

```
page-break-after: avoid;
```

```
}
```

```
.logo {
```

```
font-weight: 800;
```

letter-spacing: 0.28em;

font-size: 15pt;

color: #1a365d;

line-height: 1;

}

.logo-sub {

display: block;

font-size: 7.5pt;

font-weight: 600;

letter-spacing: 0.18em;

color: #e67e22;

margin-top: 4px;

}

.tagline {

font-size: 8.5pt;

font-weight: 600;

color: #1a365d;

opacity: 0.85;

text-align: right;

max-width: 42%;

}

.greet {

background: linear-gradient(135deg, #1a365d 0%, #234876 100%);

color: #fff;

padding: 12px 14px;

border-radius: 6px;

margin-bottom: 16px;

font-size: 11pt;

page-break-inside: avoid;

```
}

.greet strong { color: #ffb366; }

h2 {

font-size: 13pt;

font-weight: 700;

color: #1a365d;

margin: 18px 0 10px 0;

padding-left: 10px;

border-left: 5px solid #e67e22;

page-break-after: avoid;

}

.qa-grid { margin-top: 8px; }

.q-card {

position: relative;

border: 1px solid #c5d4e8;

border-radius: 8px;

padding: 10px 12px 10px 44px;

margin-bottom: 10px;

background: #fafbfd;

page-break-inside: avoid;

}

.q-num {

position: absolute;

left: 10px;

top: 10px;

width: 26px;

height: 26px;

border-radius: 50%;

background: rgba(230, 126, 34, 0.22);
```

```
color: #1a365d;

font-weight: 700;

font-size: 10pt;

text-align: center;

line-height: 26px;

}

.q-card h3 {

margin: 0 0 6px 0;

font-size: 10.5pt;

font-weight: 700;

color: #1a365d;

}

.q-body { font-size: 10.5pt; color: #2c5282; }

.q-body p { margin: 4px 0; }

.q-body ul { margin: 4px 0 4px 18px; padding: 0; }

.q-body li { margin: 2px 0; }

.roi-wrap {

margin: 16px 0;

page-break-inside: avoid;

}

.roi-title {

font-size: 10pt;

font-weight: 700;

text-transform: uppercase;

letter-spacing: 0.06em;

color: #e67e22;

margin-bottom: 8px;

}

.roi-box {
```

```
display: table;

width: 100%;

border: 2px dashed #e67e22;

border-radius: 8px;

overflow: hidden;

background: #fff8f2;

}

.roi-col {

display: table-cell;

width: 50%;

padding: 12px 14px;

vertical-align: top;

}

.roi-col:first-child { border-right: 2px dashed #e67e2244; }

.roi-label {

font-size: 8.5pt;

font-weight: 600;

color: #1a365d;

text-transform: uppercase;

letter-spacing: 0.04em;

margin-bottom: 4px;

}

.roi-value {

font-size: 14pt;

font-weight: 700;

color: #1a365d;

}

.roi-note {

font-size: 8pt;
```

```
color: #4a5568;

margin-top: 8px;

line-height: 1.4;

}

.timeline {

margin: 16px 0;

page-break-inside: avoid;

}

.timeline-title {

font-size: 10pt;

font-weight: 700;

color: #1a365d;

margin-bottom: 10px;

}

.tl-row {

display: table;

width: 100%;

table-layout: fixed;

border-spacing: 8px 0;

margin: 0 -8px;

}

.tl-step {

display: table-cell;

width: 25%;

vertical-align: top;

background: #eef2f9;

border-top: 4px solid #1a365d;

border-radius: 6px;

padding: 8px;
```

```
font-size: 9pt;

}

.tl-step strong {

display: block;

color: #e67e22;

font-size: 8pt;

margin-bottom: 4px;

letter-spacing: 0.03em;

}

.cta {

margin-top: 16px;

padding: 12px 14px;

background: #e67e22;

color: #fff;

border-radius: 8px;

font-size: 11pt;

font-weight: 600;

text-align: center;

page-break-inside: avoid;

}

.footer {

margin-top: 18px;

padding-top: 10px;

border-top: 1px solid #c5d4e8;

font-size: 8.5pt;

color: #4a5568;

text-align: center;

}
```

SCALER

ACADEMY

Move forward — structured path to stronger product/tech roles

Hi Rohan, great speaking with you today. You asked three sharp questions on our call — and you deserved sharper answers than you got in the moment. This brief is my attempt to give you exactly that, honestly and without fluff. Read it at your own pace, and let's pick up where we left off.

Your questions answered

1

Where You Are — and Why This Window Matters

Four years at TCS on HDFC and Citi. An AWS Solutions Architect cert you earned on your own time. A clear-eyed view of where service-company work plateaus. Rohan, that's not a weak starting point — that's actually a strong one. The engineers who break into product-company AI roles aren't always the ones who started earliest; they're the ones who made a deliberate, structured move at the right moment. You said it yourself: "I keep seeing AI engineering roles and wondering if I'm already too late." You're not. But the window is real, and it rewards people who move with intention rather than just accumulating more free tutorials. That's the context for everything below.

2

Q1: Why Pay ₹3.5L When Andrew Ng's Coursera Content Covers Similar Material for Free?

This is the right question to ask, and the honest answer has two parts. What free content does well: Andrew Ng's courses are genuinely excellent for conceptual grounding. If you're disciplined, self-directed, and already know what to build after the course ends, free content can take you far. You've already proven you can do this — your AWS cert is evidence of that. Where free content structurally falls short for a career switch: No accountability loop. Coursera has no mechanism to keep you on pace alongside a full-time job and a life. Scaler runs live classes three times a week with industry instructors — there's a cohort, a schedule, and people who notice if you drop off. No 1:1 mentorship with practitioners. Free platforms give you video and forums. Scaler pairs you with active industry professionals for 1:1 mentorship — people currently working in the roles you're targeting, who can tell you what actually matters in a system design interview at a product company versus what the textbook says. No structured proof of work. Hiring managers at product companies don't just want certificates — they want to see 50+ hands-on projects and real-world case studies that demonstrate you can build, not just watch. That portfolio signal is hard to replicate alone. No placement infrastructure. Scaler has 900+ hiring partners and an alumni network of 100,000+. Free content has none of that. The network effect — warm introductions, referrals, interview prep tied to specific companies — is something you simply cannot buy on Coursera. AI mock interviews with live avatars. This is a specific differentiator: structured, repeated interview simulation that mirrors what product companies actually test. The trade-off is honest: if you have unlimited time, perfect self-discipline, and strong existing networks at product companies, free content may be enough. If you're a full-time SDE-2 at TCS trying to make a deliberate switch in a defined window, the structure, accountability, and placement infrastructure are what you're actually paying for — not just the content. For a line-by-line comparison to your specific situation and what's available in your cohort, we'd be happy to share more details on your next call with admissions.

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Q2: What's the Realistic Salary Jump for Someone at Your Profile?

You were direct about this, so I'll be direct back: "If I'm going from 14 LPA at TCS to 16 at another service company, the math doesn't work." That's a completely fair line to draw. What we can honestly say from verified data: Scaler publishes a median salary hike of approximately 110% for the Data Science & ML track on their website. That figure is for that specific track and is a median — meaning half the cohort is above it and half below. It does not automatically apply to your profile, your geography, or other program tracks. What we won't do: Quote you a

personal salary number. Anyone who does that in a sales call without knowing your interview performance, target companies, and market conditions at the time of your search is making something up. You deserve better than that. What is worth thinking through: The move you're describing — from service-company SDE-2 to a product-company AI engineering role — is a role-type switch, not just a company switch. That kind of transition, when executed well, typically carries a different compensation ceiling than a lateral service-to-service move. Your AWS cert already signals you can learn independently; adding structured AI engineering depth and a product-company-ready portfolio changes the conversation you can have with a hiring manager. For salary benchmarks that are specific to your experience level, target role type, and geography, we'd be happy to share more details on your next call with admissions — that's a conversation worth having with real numbers, not estimates in a PDF.

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Q3: Does the Program Cover Hands-On LLM Development — RAG, Agents, Evals — or Is It Mostly Theoretical ML?

This is the question that matters most for where you want to go, and the answer from the verified curriculum is encouraging. What is explicitly in the program: Prompt Engineering — foundational to working with LLMs in production RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation) — explicitly listed in the AI & Agents module Multi-agent orchestration — also explicitly listed Agentic AI Elective — a dedicated elective track for this area These are not theoretical survey topics — they are the building blocks of the AI engineering roles you're describing. The program also includes 50+ hands-on projects, which means you're building with these tools, not just reading about them. On evals specifically: Evaluation frameworks for LLM applications are an active and evolving area. The verified curriculum lists the topics above; for the precise depth of coverage on evals and how that module is structured in your cohort, we'd be happy to share more details on your next call with admissions — that's worth confirming directly rather than guessing here. The broader point: You said "I want to build real LLM applications." The curriculum is oriented toward that — RAG and agents are applied engineering topics, not academic ML theory. Combined with the project portfolio and mentorship from practitioners, this is designed for people who want to ship things, not just pass exams.

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Your Specific Situation: What Makes This a Credible Move

Let's be concrete about why your profile is well-positioned — not as flattery, but as a practical assessment: 4 YoE in banking tech (HDFC, Citi): You understand production systems, client constraints, and real-world engineering tradeoffs. That's not nothing — product companies building fintech or enterprise AI tools actively value this context. AWS Solutions Architect cert: You've already demonstrated you can learn independently and pass a rigorous technical certification. The entrance test Scaler requires for admission is a gate, not a wall — your background suggests you can clear it. B.Tech CSE from VIT: Strong CS fundamentals that the DSA and System Design modules will build on, not replace. The gap between where you are and where you want to go is real but bridgeable. The question is whether you bridge it with a structured program that compresses the timeline and adds placement infrastructure, or with free content that may take longer and leave the job-search piece entirely to you. Next step — the entrance test: Admission to Scaler requires clearing an entrance test, which gates access to the second call and enrollment. This is worth taking seriously as a first concrete step. For prep resources, retake policies, and what to expect, we'd be happy to share more details on your next call with admissions.

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What Happens Next

You've asked the right questions. Here's what a clear path forward looks like: Review this brief — flag anything that still feels unanswered or that you want to pressure-test. Book your next call with admissions — bring your specific questions on salary benchmarks for your profile, cohort-level curriculum depth on evals, and EMI/financing options.

Those are conversations worth having with real data in front of you. Take the entrance test — it's the concrete first step toward enrollment, and your background puts you in a strong position to clear it. You're not too late. But the engineers who make this switch successfully are the ones who move deliberately rather than waiting for perfect certainty. This is a good moment to take the next step.

ROI snapshot · illustrative

Today (typical services background)

■ —

Your current package depends on role & city — we'll personalise this on your next call.

Target trajectory (post-upskilling)

↑ Product / tech

Outcomes vary by effort & market. We discuss realistic ranges with admissions — never a blind promise.

Career path momentum

NOW Baseline skills audit & entrance clarity

0–4 MODSA · system building blocks · habits

4–8 MO Full stack depth · design · AI agents elective

8–12 MO Interview readiness · referrals · rounds

Book your next admissions call — bring your questions, and let's get you specific answers.

Prepared for Rohan Sharma | 07 May 2026 | Scaler Academy